

Mark Smalley

Digital Assets Product · Stablecoins and Tokenised Settlement · Financial Services

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Lloyds Banking Group

Re: Digital Assets Product Manager, Associate Director (163276)

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Digital Assets Product Manager role in your new Business & Commercial Banking Digital Assets team. Your first priority, rolling out stablecoin-based transfers, is close to work I have already done: I led the design of a securities regulator's blockchain pilot that used a stablecoin as on-chain money for investment subscriptions, settlement and refunds.

Project Castor ran for two years, from educating the regulator to a working pilot unveiled as its blockchain blueprint in 2018. Alongside the stablecoin settlement leg, it included smart contract escrow that released funds when a raise met its target and refunded investors when it did not, standalone KYC and AML contracts, and a read-only node that let the regulator supervise every transaction in real time. Its findings fed into a new custodian framework, and I went on to architect the compliance, KYC/AML and custody infrastructure for the first custodian approved under it.

That work taught me that digital money products succeed or fail on controls, governance and operational readiness as much as on technology. I am used to writing requirements with Risk, Compliance and Legal in the room, designing controls into the product rather than around it, and explaining trade-offs to senior stakeholders. At Oviato I made the case to pivot from a consumer app to business-to-business wallet infrastructure, and at CakeDefi I built a new product team from one to ten people and took a marketplace prototype to public launch within four months.

My background is in pilots and new products rather than running an established payments business, and I would lean on your Payments Product colleagues for that depth. What I bring is a hands-on understanding of how stablecoins and on-chain settlement actually behave, which helps turn an emerging capability into something clients trust.

I am based in Yorkshire, and your Manchester office would suit two days a week. I would welcome the chance to discuss how I could help build the team's first digital money propositions.

Yours sincerely,

Mark Smalley